

CLOUD KITCHEN AND DELIVERY-ONLY FOOD SAFETY STANDARDS, 2026 (ILLUSTRATIVE)

Sample document generated for RAG test-dataset purposes — not an official publication

1. Licensing

1.1 Every cloud kitchen with an annual turnover above Rs. 12 lakh must hold a valid State food safety licence, renewable every 5 years. 1.2 A kitchen operating more than 3 delivery-only brands from a single premises must display all licence numbers on each brand's ordering page.

2. Temperature Control

2.1 Cooked food awaiting dispatch shall not be held at a temperature below 60°C for hot items or above 5°C for cold items for more than 2 hours. 2.2 Any food held outside these ranges beyond the 2-hour limit shall be discarded and not dispatched for delivery.

3. Packaging and Labelling

3.1 Every delivered item must carry a label showing preparation time and a recommended consumption window of not more than 2 hours from dispatch for perishable items. 3.2 Packaging materials must be food-grade certified and tamper-evident seals are mandatory for all orders above Rs. 300.

4. Hygiene Audits

4.1 A cloud kitchen shall undergo a surprise hygiene audit at least once every 6 months. 4.2 A kitchen scoring below 60% on an audit shall be given 15 days to remediate, failing which its licence shall be suspended until re-inspection.

5. Consumer Complaints

5.1 A platform listing cloud kitchens must forward any food-safety complaint to the concerned kitchen and the local food safety office within 24 hours of receipt. 5.2 A kitchen with 3 or more substantiated food-safety complaints within a rolling 90-day period shall be delisted from all platforms pending investigation.